



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ordo Amoris Classical Academy
School Website: <https://oaclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Ordo Amoris Classical Academy (OAC) in Beulah, Michigan (MI 49617) presents a clearly classical Christian education model, delivered as a homeschool-hybrid with strong parental partnership. Across public-facing materials, the school foregrounds its classical aims (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, liberal arts), its telos toward virtue and wisdom, and a covenantal, community-based approach that centers families as co-teachers. In short, the materials demonstrate robust alignment with core classical education signals, including a strong religious-metaphysical frame, a formation-focused purpose, a curriculum anchored in liberal arts and Great Books, explicit classical pedagogy practices (narration, memory work, imitation), and a family-centered community ethos. The public content also emphasizes a distinctive identity—Ordo Amoris (Latin for Rightly Ordered Loves)—and a visible commitment to catechetical and liturgical framing within a Christian classroom ethos. Overall, the school is rated CLASSICAL, with only minor indications of pedagogical practices that are less explicitly documented as classical (see Element 4). The aggregate assessment reflects strong classical alignment across categories, with Element 4 showing partial alignment rather than full classical pedagogy, thus a CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY picture that reinforces an overall CLASSICAL classification.

- Executive judgment: The school demonstrates clear and consistent alignment with classical education foundations across most dimensions, including religious-metaphysical grounding, formation-focused goals, a Great Books-informed curriculum, and a family-centric, teacher-mentored instructional model. The aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle? For a strictly CLASSICAL designation with perfect alignment, nothing major is required. The strongest opportunities to tighten alignment would be to make explicit any Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades and to foreground explicit statements about Socratic dialogue, Paideia-style seminars, or explicit rational rhetoric pedagogy across the upper grades to close any remaining gaps with the canonical Pedagogy quadrant.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: The public materials consistently frame education through a Christian, covenantal lens, citing nurture and admonition of the Lord and a mission formed around God-centered aims (e.g., “partnering with families to educate children in the nurture and admonition of the Lord”; Latin name Ordo Amoris; Psalm 78:5–7; Covenant language).
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include God, virtue, telos, order of loves, nurture/admonition, covenant, Great Books, Great Poieses, and the Great Conversation themes embedded in the curriculum. Negative keywords from the lexicon (relativism, secular humanism, values-clarification, morally neutral) are not evidenced in the public materials. Estimated: Positive matches approx. 6–9; Negative matches approx. 0. Classification justification: The materials articulate transcendentals and sacred formation, with explicit theology-integration and liturgical/communal cues evident in the school's language and mission. Why this rating: The religious-metaphysical foundations are central and explicit, aligning with the Classical model's emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable, and the integration of theology and liturgy into the school life.

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- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, and the belief that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable; the curriculum aims at human flourishing rather than mere job-readiness (e.g., “true education should be directed toward the telos... of the cultivation of persons in wisdom, virtue and godliness”; avoidance of an exclusive emphasis on workforce preparation). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, Great Books, and liberal education; Negative signals from the lexicon (college/career readiness, 21st-century skills) are not prominent in the public materials. Estimated: Positive approx. 5–7; Negative approx. 0–1. Classification justification: The school presents education as formation toward human excellence and moral imagination, consistent with classical aims rather than a narrow vocational focus. Why this rating: The stated purpose centers on virtue and wisdom, not solely job prep, and integrates a formation-oriented teleology (telos) aligned with classical education signals.
 - **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school's materials reference liberal arts education, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, primary sources, and Western civilization; explicit mention of “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” and the liberal-arts framework appears in governance and curricular materials (e.g., portraits and curriculum references). The curriculum is described with references to classical content and aims (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; Latin/Greek; classical literature; and other classic humanities).
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal education, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Western civilization, Latin/Greek, history as discipline, and poetry/literature; Negative signals (social-studies re-labelling of history, STEM-first framing) are not evidenced. Estimated: Positive approx. 6–9; Negative approx. 0–1. Classification justification: The curriculum strongly aligns with classical content and priorities, including engagement with Great Books and classical humanities, rather than contemporary secular or vocational framing. Why this rating: The explicit curriculum language and structure map onto classic liberal-arts and classical texts, with clear emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books.
 - **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site describes master-apprentice mentorship, imitation, narration/recitation, and memory-work as foundational pedagogy (e.g., “Instructing is mentoring, and is essentially a master-apprenticeship relationship.”; emphasis on imitation; recitation; memory). There are explicit references to contemplative/restful learning and to the use of memory devices (chanting, singing) in lower grades; upper grades are said to use Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in some traditions, though explicit, classroom-wide Socratic seminars are not consistently documented across the site.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include narration, recitation, chanting, memory, master-apprentice, imitation, seminar-style discourse in some contexts, and rhetoric; negative signals in the lexicon include projects-focused, experiential-only approaches and constructivist trends. The public materials show a mix: strong traditional methods (narration/recitation/memory) but less explicit, universal documentation of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars across all grades. Estimated: Positive matches approx. 5–7; Negative matches approx. 0–2 (depending on whether one counts the absence of explicit “Socratic seminars” as a negative indicator). Classification justification: The pedagogy strongly reflects classical traits (memory, recitation, imitation) but lacks explicit universal documentation of Socratic/Seminar pedagogy in every grade, suggesting a partial but not complete alignment with the Pedagogy category. Why this rating: The school employs several core classical pedagogy methods (memory, narration, imitation, master-apprentice teaching) and a contemplative/restful dimension, but the absence of explicit, universal Socratic seminar documentation lowers it from full CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The materials describe faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with emphasis on virtuous exemplars, character formation, and a collegial, shared-learning environment; there is a sense of a “portrait of a teacher” and a “faculty of friends” core to the school. This framing appears in admissions materials and in the portrait-language of graduates and faculty. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, mentors/masters, virtuous exemplars, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture; negative signals (e.g., overly credential-

driven or “facilitator” roles) are not evidenced. Estimated: Positive approx. 5–6; Negative approx. 0. Classification justification: The school promotes a living, mentorship-driven, character-formation-centered faculty model that aligns closely with classical expectations. Why this rating: The living-curriculum and mentor-teacher emphasis matches core classical faculty ideals.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers, parental formation through websites, book studies, gatherings, and parent involvement in school life; there are references to open campus access and parent covenant language. This is visible in admissions language, covenant materials, and community-building descriptions. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, book studies, seminars, open campus, family liturgy; negative signals (consumer language, minimal parental involvement) are not evidenced. Estimated: Positive approx. 6–7; Negative approx. 0. Classification justification: The school presents a deeply parental-collaborative model with active parent involvement and formation, a strong hallmark of classical schooling’s community orientation. Why this rating: The parental co-teaching model and active parental formation align well with classical categories in the lexicon.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: The school demonstrates strong classical alignment across five of the six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community) with Pedagogy showing substantial classical alignment but not uniformly documented as full Socratic seminar pedagogy. The aggregate indicates CLASSICAL with a single area (Pedagogy) that is MOSTLY classical rather than fully classical in every grade, hence still CLASSICAL overall.

What Would Move the Needle - If aiming for a stronger, explicit universal classical pedagogy across all grades, the school could: - Document and implement uniform Socratic/Paideia-style seminars or seminars in upper grades, with clear scaffolding and assessment. - Expand explicit reference to classical seminar methodology (Socratic discussion, Paideia-style teaching) in public-facing materials for all grades to reinforce the Pedagogy alignment. - Continue to foreground “memory work” and “chanting” in lower grades with explicit connections to classical pedagogy (and potentially integrate them with more explicit Latin/Greek ritual or recitation cycles).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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